AUTO FINANCE / UK DOMAIN GUIDE

From choosing a vehicle to signing the agreement.

A connected reference for UK vehicle finance: products, practical use cases, brands and providers, commercial decisions, customer protections and the evidence needed at each step.

UK market · GBP

Researched 13 October 2026

Public-source reference · v1.0

Single file · works offline

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01 / ORIENTATION

Three questions shape the journey.

What vehicle fits the actual use?

Start with journeys, passengers, load, annual mileage, parking, fuel or charging access, and running budget. Then choose new or used, body style, powertrain and specification.

Is the aim ownership or use?

HP and conditional sale work towards ownership. PCP offers an end-of-term choice. Contract hire pays for use and return. A personal loan separates the borrowing from the vehicle purchase.

The third question: who signs and pays? A private individual, sole trader and limited company are different counterparties. The legal agreement, regulated status, credit process and tax treatment must match the actual customer.

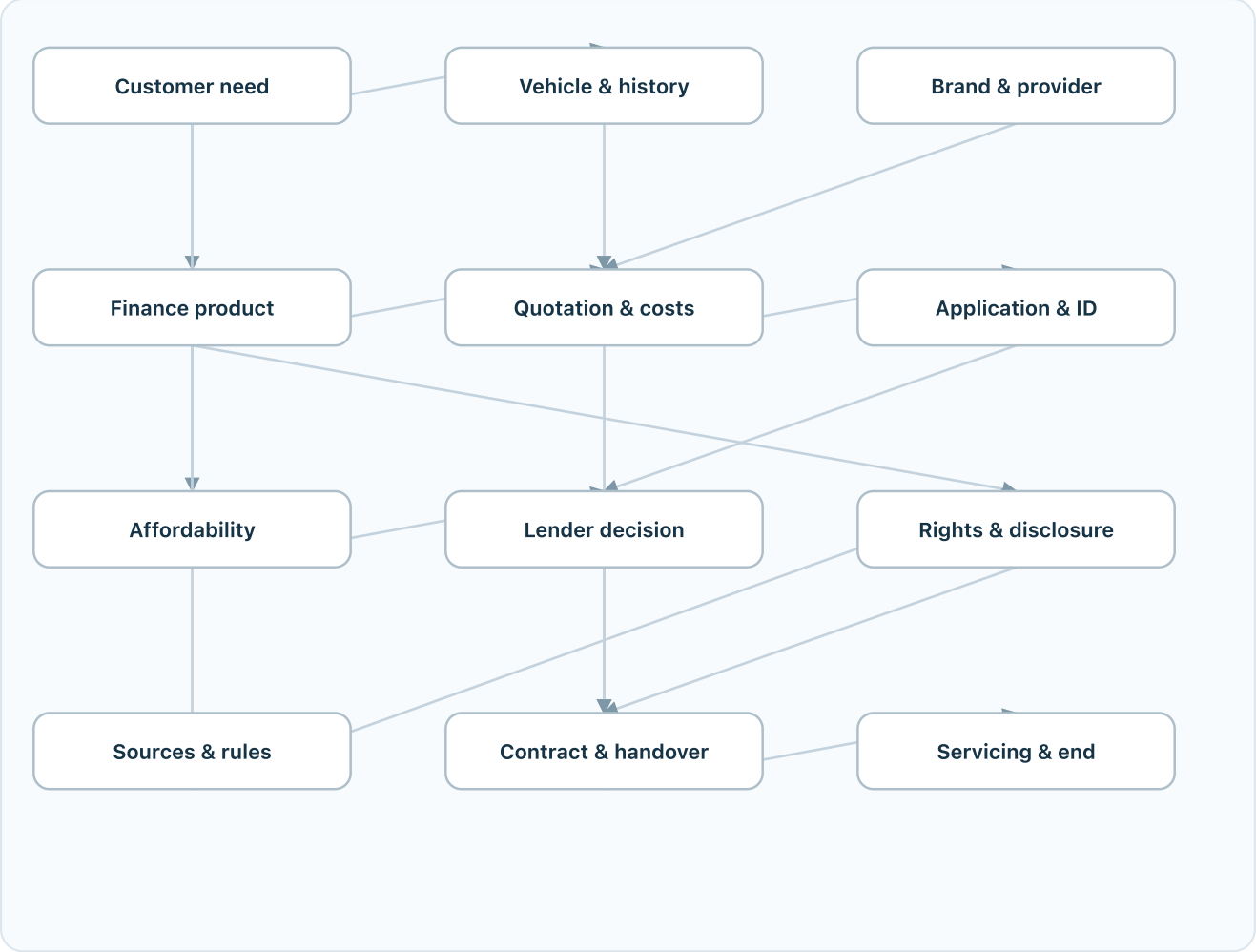
> This guide explains the domain and proposes review questions. It is not a lender's approved policy, personalised financial advice, or a live price list. Product names alone do not establish legal rights; the signed agreement and applicable law control.

Overview: MoneyHelper · buying a car

02 / CONNECTED DOMAIN

Knowledge graph

Arrows describe conceptual relationships across the UK auto finance journey. The relationship list follows on the next page. This authored domain map is separate from the application's saved requirement and test-coverage graph.



Read the relationships as text

- Customer need → Vehicle & history: shapes selection
- Customer need → Finance product: shapes product fit
- Customer need → Affordability: sets budget context
- Vehicle & history → Quotation & costs: specification and price
- Brand & provider → Quotation & costs: supplies the offer
- Finance product → Quotation & costs: defines payment structure
- Quotation & costs → Application & ID: accepted proposal
- Application & ID → Lender decision: customer evidence
- Affordability → Lender decision: assessment input
- Finance product → Rights & disclosure: rights depend on form
- Rights & disclosure → Contract & handover: informed agreement
- Lender decision → Contract & handover: approval conditions
- Quotation & costs → Contract & handover: agreed financial terms
- Sources & rules → Rights & disclosure: public guidance
- Sources & rules → Finance product: definitions and approved rules
- Contract & handover → Servicing & end: defines obligations and choices

03 / PRODUCT CATALOGUE

Products and UK use cases

Use cases below illustrate reasons to compare a product, not recommendations or acceptance guarantees. Deposits, terms, mileage, fees and eligibility vary by lender and vehicle.

HP Ownership

Hire Purchase

Deposit plus instalments pays down the financed price. The finance company retains ownership until the agreement's final payments and any purchase fee are satisfied.

Use case: someone planning to keep the car, rather than routinely return it; a business buying a work vehicle.

Consider: full repayment commitment, total interest, early settlement, fees, insurance and lender restrictions. A conventional HP plan has no PCP-style optional balloon; confirm the actual schedule.

MoneyHelper · HP

PCP End choice

Personal Contract Purchase

Deposit, regular instalments and an optional final payment. Ownership requires paying that final sum and applicable fees. Return or replacement may be alternatives under the terms.

Use case: a driver wanting a choice at the end, with predictable usage and willingness to manage return conditions.

Consider: annual mileage, vehicle condition, the amount needed to keep it, interest on outstanding finance, and an end-of-term plan. Trade-in equity is not guaranteed; replacement requires a new deal. Business contract purchase must be checked against its own agreement.

MoneyHelper · PCP

CS Ownership

Conditional Sale

Instalment purchase with title transferring when the contract's conditions, including payments, are fulfilled. Unlike HP, ownership is generally automatic when those conditions are met.

Use case: purchasing a new or used car through a dealer offering this legal form.

Consider: repayment schedule, ownership conditions, regulated status, settlement and default provisions. A balloon variant defers a repayment obligation; it does not automatically add PCP return rights. Do not treat "conditional sale" as leasing just because a monthly payment is advertised.

Stellantis · Peugeot finance Santander · conditional sale

LP Balloon commitment

Lease Purchase

Purchase finance with a substantial deferred balloon. It is typically a payment commitment, rather than PCP's optional purchase payment with a contractual return alternative.

Use case: a customer or business planning ownership and able to fund the deferred balance.

Consider: a balloon funding plan, resale risk, settlement and refinancing eligibility. Refinancing is a future credit decision, not a guaranteed solution; ask whether any return or resale undertaking actually exists.

VWFS · lease purchase information

PCH Use & return

Personal Contract Hire

A lease for private use: initial rental followed by regular rentals, with return at the end. Usually no contractual option to buy.

Use case: a driver wanting vehicle access rather than ownership, with a reasonably stable mileage forecast.

Consider: total rentals, initial rental rather than refundable deposit, mileage charge, maintenance inclusions, condition standard and early termination charge. Insurance and running costs need their own budget.

MoneyHelper · PCH

BCH Business use

Business Contract Hire

Business vehicle use through agreed rentals and return conditions. Maintenance may be packaged separately. The lessor owns the vehicle.

Use case: a company fleet or business seeking a defined replacement cycle without buying the asset.

Consider: legal entity, authorised signer, guarantees, private use, mileage, net/VAT/gross pricing and who bears each operating cost. Business finance is not automatically unregulated or tax deductible.

Alphabet · leasing solutions HMRC · motoring VAT

BFL / FL Residual risk

Business Finance Lease

The business rents an asset, with full-payout or balloon structures depending on the product. The lessor retains legal title; end disposal, proceeds and secondary rentals depend on the terms.

Use case: a business that can manage asset-use and end-value obligations, including commercial vehicles.

Consider: residual exposure, responsibility for sale, proceeds allocation, secondary period and tax/accounting classification. Do not assume the customer can simply buy the vehicle directly from the lessor.

Alphabet · finance lease VWFS · finance lease guides

PFL Contract-defined label

Personal Finance Lease

This label exists in the project's reference catalogue and some provider naming. It does not establish one uniform UK retail product structure.

Use case: analyse it only when a provider supplies the actual product definition.

Consider: legal form, ownership, whether a final sum is mandatory, return rights, mileage, VAT and regulation. Leave unknown fields unresolved; do not infer PCP or PCH behaviour from "personal" or "lease".

Project: `workspace/auto-finance-domain.toml`. Naming example: Stellantis trading-name disclosure

Personal loan | Separate borrowing

Unsecured Personal Loan

Borrow money and buy the car separately, usually owning it from purchase. The loan remains repayable even if the vehicle is sold or damaged.

Use case: buying from a private seller or dealer while comparing bank borrowing with dealer finance.

Consider: actual offered APR, total loan repayments, early repayment terms and purchase protections. Vehicle return does not by itself cancel a separate loan.

MoneyHelper · personal loans

Alternatives | Cash / subscription

Cash, Subscription & Salary Sacrifice

Cash purchase avoids borrowing but uses savings. Subscription is a provider-defined access package; verify inclusions and cancellation. Salary sacrifice is an employer benefit arrangement, often backed by a fleet lease, rather than a universal consumer credit product.

Use case: compare access needs, available cash, short-term flexibility or an employer scheme.

Consider: emergency savings, subscription fees, employer eligibility, gross-pay impact, benefit-in-kind, insurance and employment-exit terms. Compare net household costs using the actual scheme and current tax year.

MoneyHelper · purchase alternatives HMRC · salary sacrifice

BCP | Business end choice

Business Contract Purchase

Business purchase finance with a deposit, regular payments and end alternatives such as keeping the car by paying the agreed future value, replacing it or returning under mileage/condition terms.

Use case: a business wanting an ownership option and a defined end-of-term choice rather than pure rental.

Consider: permitted business entity, legal/regulatory status, mileage, condition, optional final sum and tax/accounting treatment. A provider's non-regulated company product is not automatically suitable for a sole trader.

Santander · contract purchase

Fleet arrangement | Existing assets

Sale and Leaseback

A business sells eligible owned vehicles to a provider and leases them back, releasing asset value while continuing to use the fleet.

Use case: a business comparing working-capital needs with the costs of keeping vehicle ownership.

Consider: sale valuation, existing security/finance, vehicle eligibility, replacement policy, future rental cost and end rights. This is an asset transaction plus lease, not free cash or the same as refinancing an individual's PCP balloon.

Alphabet · sale and leaseback

04 / DECISION LENS

Compare the structure before the monthly price.

Typical structures; the actual agreement can add conditions or differ.

Product	Ownership path	Final payment / return	Key exposure
HP / CS	Ownership after contractual conditions met	Normal final instalment; HP may have purchase fee	Full financing cost; settlement and default terms
PCP	Optional purchase at end	Pay optional final sum, return under terms, or arrange replacement	Balloon funding; mileage / condition on return; no guaranteed equity
Business contract purchase	Business ownership option	Keep, replace or return as contracted	Business eligibility, future value, mileage and condition
LP	Purchase route	Deferred balloon generally due; no automatic PCP-style return	Refinancing and vehicle value risk
PCH / BCH	Lessor owns	Return; no standard purchase option	Mileage, damage and early-exit charges
Finance lease	Lessor owns	Disposal / secondary period as agreed	Residual and disposal obligations
Personal loan	Buyer owns purchased car	Repay loan; vehicle disposal separate	Loan liability survives vehicle disposal

Suggested comparison method: align the vehicle, cash price, term, deposit/initial rental, usage and included services. Compare total cash paid for use separately from total paid to acquire ownership. A lower instalment can conceal a larger final payment or initial rental.

Sources: product references above. Comparison method is an editorial checklist.

05 / UK MARKET ECOSYSTEM

Vehicle brands, finance brands and lenders

The badge on the vehicle, the dealer, the broker and the legal lender can be different organisations. These are representative examples, not a ranking or exhaustive register; availability depends on the current offer and customer.

Brand / channel	Public product examples	What to verify
Volkswagen Group channels	VWFS lists purchase and leasing products and serves group brands. Examples include Volkswagen, Audi, Škoda, SEAT and CUPRA.	Brand trading name, actual lender, chosen product, used/new eligibility and campaign terms. VWFS · Brand relationships
BMW	BMW Select is PCP; HP and PCH are separate alternatives.	Optional final payment, return conditions and provider entity. BMW Select
MINI	MINI Select / HP; MINI Financial Services is a BMW Financial Services trading name.	Retailer introduction scope and exact contract rather than marketing shorthand. MINI finance
Mercedes-Benz	Agility is a PCP-style personal contract plan; other purchase and leasing options are distinct.	Optional purchase payment, mileage, documents and included costs. Agility
Ford	Ford Options, Ford Acquire, Cashplan and contract hire are separate offerings.	Map the named plan to its legal form and payment schedule; distinguish Ford Credit from lease arrangements. Ford plans
Toyota	PCP, HP and PCH are described on Toyota's finance pages; PCH can involve KINTO.	Actual contracting provider, warranty/maintenance inclusions and final payment. Toyota finance
Lexus	PCP, PCH and HP for new and approved pre-owned vehicles; PCH page identifies KINTO ownership.	Vehicle eligibility and which entity supplies the agreement. Lexus finance
Stellantis channels	Group finance website has brand-specific options. Peugeot lists PCP, PCH and Conditional Sale.	Select the current brand page; do not apply one brand's plan to all group vehicles. Brand directory · Peugeot
Independent / multi-brand finance	Black Horse describes HP and PCP. Santander Consumer Finance has retail motor-finance products.	Dealer lender panel, broker fees, commission, quote and legal lender. Black Horse · Santander

Brand / channel	Public product examples	What to verify
Fleet / leasing provider	Alphabet describes business leasing, including finance lease.	Fleet policy, driver responsibilities, mileage, maintenance and end disposal. Alphabet

For any brand: request the dealer's broker role, lender identity, finance-provider panel and remuneration explanation. Verify the firm's permissions and genuine contact details with the FCA Firm Checker. A familiar vehicle badge is not proof of lender authorisation.

06 / END-TO-END JOURNEY

Vehicle selection → agreement → handover

Each stage includes practical review questions, required evidence and exceptions to resolve. This is a proposed domain analysis checklist; the lender's approved procedures determine the actual gates.

01 Define customer needs and budget

Consider

- Private or business use; intended keeper, payer and legal signer.
- Ownership preference, holding period, expected mileage and likely life changes.
- Monthly transport budget plus initial funds, emergency savings and any final payment plan.
- Insurance, servicing, fuel/charging, tax, tyres, parking and repairs.

Evidence / questions

- Document needs and a realistic budget; distinguish affordability from credit approval.
- Ask whether irregular income, accessibility or support needs require a different communication process.
- Exception: unaffordable vehicle or uncertain usage → revisit vehicle/term before applying.

MoneyHelper · running budget FCA · affordability

02 Select vehicle, powertrain and specification

Consider

- New, pre-registered, demonstrator or used; actual model year, trim and optional equipment.
- Petrol, diesel, hybrid, plug-in hybrid or battery EV: match actual driving and charging access.
- Insurance quotation, service network, warranty, lead time, depreciation and local access charges.
- EV: realistic winter/motorway range, battery condition/warranty, home installation and public charging costs.

Evidence / questions

- Record make, model, derivative, specification, availability and agreed price.
- Test drive and confirm suitability; avoid assuming a finance approval covers any substitute vehicle.
- Exception: factory delay or specification change → reconfirm quote, campaign expiry and lender acceptance.

Practical vehicle review questions; budget reference: MoneyHelper .

03 Validate seller and vehicle history

Consider

- Check registration, VIN, DVLA details, V5C, MOT history and safety recalls where applicable.
- Review servicing evidence, condition, mileage consistency, accident/write-off history and any outstanding finance through suitable checks.
- Confirm seller identity, ability to sell and warranty/return terms. A V5C identifies a keeper; do not treat it alone as proof of legal title.

Evidence / questions

- Keep dated inspection/history reports and agreed defects/repairs; consider independent inspection.
- Confirm the lender accepts the seller and vehicle age/mileage; thresholds are lender-specific.
- Exception: VIN mismatch, finance marker or suspicious payment instruction → resolve before paying or signing.

GOV.UK · used-vehicle checks

04 Select product and compare channels

Consider

- Compare ownership, final balance, return options, usage limits and exit exposure.
- Dealer/captive finance, independent lender, leasing broker and separate personal loan.
- Customer legal type, regulated status and business/private use before choosing PCH or BCH.
- Separate optional add-ons from vehicle and finance; assess actual need and price.

Evidence / questions

- Request equivalent written quotes with total cost and inclusions.
- Ask whether the broker considers one lender or a panel, and how commission is explained.
- Exception: cheapest instalment depends on an unaffordable balloon → compare another structure.

MoneyHelper · options FCA · commission disclosure

05 Agree vehicle price, trade-in and quotation

Consider

- Separate cash price, discount, customer deposit, contribution, part-exchange value and old finance settlement.
- Confirm outstanding settlement with the old lender and its expiry; negative equity needs explicit treatment.
- Review actual APR, payment count/timing, fees, total payable, balloon and offer validity.
- For leases confirm initial rental profile, subsequent rental count, mileage and VAT basis.

Evidence / questions

- Keep quote version, vehicle identity, inputs, calculation output and old settlement reference.
- Explain who clears old finance and when; do not count trade-in gross value as free deposit.
- Exception: price, mileage, term or settlement changes → new quote and any required credit reassessment.

Quotation reconciliation is a proposed review checklist; product references in section 03.

06 Application, identity and permissions

Consider

- Submit accurate identity, address, employment/income, expenditure and bank information required by the lender.
- Business applications may require company details, financial information, signing authority or a guarantee.
- Understand privacy notice, lawful data use and what check is soft versus hard; marketing permission is separate.

Evidence / questions

- Keep application reference and disclosed check/data permissions, through approved secure channels.
- Confirm required documents and accessibility support; avoid unnecessary repeated applications.
- Exception: mismatch, incomplete evidence or duplicate submission → correct and reconcile before proceeding.

FCA · sales and credit assessment ICO · data rights

07 Creditworthiness, affordability and lender decision

Consider

- Credit risk asks whether repayment is likely; affordability considers whether payment causes financial harm.
- Acceptance may include conditions, revised terms, guarantor requirements or manual review.
- Lender rules define eligibility, evidence and decision thresholds; none are universal in this guide.

Evidence / questions

- Record decision, conditions, validity and the accepted vehicle/product/quote.
- Clarify approval in principle versus a completed agreement; never treat pending as accepted.
- Exception: decline, referral or revised price → explain next steps and reconfirm acceptance of new terms.

FCA · creditworthiness and affordability

08 Pre-contract information and adequate explanation

Consider

- Read the pre-contract credit information where applicable, agreement draft and product explanation.
- Understand payment obligations, ownership, optional/mandatory final amount, default consequences and exit rights.
- Commission disclosures should be understandable, prominent and timely; ask about the arrangement.
- Ask about warranty, maintenance and insurance exclusions; optional products need a separate decision.

Evidence / questions

- Retain documents in a durable form and a record of questions answered before signing.
- Check that the explanation matches the customer's understanding, not just a ticked box.
- Exception: unexplained final payment or conflicting documents → seek correction before consent.

FCA · pre-contract explanations FCA · commission

09 Final agreement review and signature

Consider

- Match customer/entity, lender, vehicle, price, deposit, instalments, final payment and fees to the accepted quote.
- Confirm annual mileage, return condition, service duties, VAT, first payment and direct debit details.
- Read settlement, withdrawal, termination, complaint, late-payment and repossession provisions as applicable.
- Check all offer conditions and business signing/guarantee authority.

Evidence / questions

- Keep the final version and signed copy, signature timestamp and acceptance confirmation.
- Verify a change has not silently replaced the product or quote; resolve differences before signature.
- Exception: expired approval, missing signatory or document mismatch → return for correction.

Proposed contract gate; disclosure basis: FCA CONC 4.2 .

10 Funding, delivery and account activation

Consider

- Supplier checks, deposit receipt, satisfied lender conditions, release of funds and delivery readiness.
- Insurance, tax/registration, agreed repairs, keys, accessories, charging cables and handover condition.
- Agree what triggers contract commencement, first payment and servicing responsibilities.

Evidence / questions

- Keep delivery acknowledgement, condition/mileage record, receipts, welcome pack and payment schedule.
- Confirm old finance settlement and new account are reconciled; lender processes control activation.
- Exception: delayed/no delivery, missing items or damaged vehicle → document and resolve with the responsible party.

GOV.UK · registration, insurance and tax

11 Plan servicing and the end before signing

Consider

- Payments, annual mileage, servicing, address changes and support if financial circumstances change.
- HP/CS: settlement or completion. PCP: keep, return or arrange replacement. LP: fund the balloon.
- Lease: inspection, condition, mileage and collection. Finance lease: agreed disposal or secondary term.

Evidence / questions

- Keep service records, settlement quotes, inspections and closure confirmations.
- Understand voluntary termination separately from surrender or lease early exit; contact the lender promptly if struggling.
- Exception: negative equity, damage dispute or balloon funding gap → obtain product-specific options early.

MoneyHelper · early exit BVRLA · return considerations

07 / FINANCIAL LITERACY

Know what the quote is charging for.

Purchase-finance reconciliation

Reconcile vehicle price, discounts, deposits, approved contributions, old settlement, financed extras and fees individually. Principal depends on which amounts the agreement finances.

Total customer outlay includes applicable upfront cash, scheduled payments, final payment and fees. Do not count a fee twice or omit a balloon. APR and a flat or nominal interest rate are different measures.

Lease reconciliation

Initial rental + actual number of subsequent rentals + disclosed fees gives scheduled lease cash outlay. Add usage/condition charges only as separately identified assumptions.

A rental advertised “6 + 35” means six rental units initially plus 35 regular rentals under that stated profile; verify the schedule. The initial rental is generally a payment for the lease, not a refundable security deposit.

Illustrative numbers — not a quotation or APR calculation

Trade-in: £10,000 valuation − £7,500 old settlement = £2,500 potential equity before other adjustments. If settlement is £11,000 instead, the shortfall is £1,000; agree its treatment explicitly.

PCP cash totals: £3,000 deposit + 36 × £300 = £13,800 scheduled deposit/instalments. A hypothetical £10,000 optional final payment makes ownership cash outlay £23,800 before any additional fee. A permitted return does not pay that optional purchase sum, but condition/mileage and other contractual charges can apply. These numbers do not derive an interest rate.

Lease: 6 × £250 initial rental + 35 × £250 subsequent rentals = £10,250, excluding any separate fee. Confirm whether each amount includes VAT; do not count the initial rental again as six monthly instalments.

Suggested quote stress review: how would changed mileage, delayed delivery, reduced income, a resale shortfall or an unfunded balloon affect this deal? Obtain actual lender calculations for settlement and contractual pricing rather than estimating legal liability from the remaining instalments.

MoneyHelper · PCP costs MoneyHelper · lease costs . Examples and reconciliation checklist are editorial illustrations.

08 / UK-SPECIFIC CONSIDERATIONS

Rights, risk and commercial obligations

Withdrawal is different from returning a car

Many regulated credit agreements have a 14-day withdrawal right under section 66A, with repayment of credit and accrued interest generally required within 30 days of notice. Check applicability and the triggering dates.

Withdrawing from credit does not automatically unwind the vehicle purchase. Distance-sale cancellation and defective-vehicle rights are separate; buying at a dealership does not create a universal cooling-off right.

MoneyHelper · withdrawal CCA · s66A Consumer rights

Settlement, termination and surrender

Early settlement repays a lender-calculated balance. Eligible regulated HP/conditional-sale agreements can have voluntary termination rights under sections 99–100, commonly involving liability up to half the total price plus relevant outstanding liabilities and reasonable-care obligations.

For PCP the half-total figure includes the balloon, so it is not half the months or half the vehicle cash price. You may need to make up a shortfall; termination can be exercised before reaching that amount. Voluntary surrender can leave a balance after sale. Lease early exit follows its own terms.

MoneyHelper · ending finance CCA · s99 CCA · s100

Quality, description and complaints

Consumer purchases from a trader have rights concerning satisfactory quality, fitness for purpose and description. Remedies depend on circumstances, timing and the agreement. The finance company may be the responsible supplier under vehicle finance; identify the right counterparty.

Keep the advert, inspection, agreement and correspondence. Use the firm’s complaint process, then the Financial Ombudsman where eligible. Private-sale protection differs from trader-sale protection.

MoneyHelper · consumer rights Financial Ombudsman · car finance

Commission and Consumer Duty

Understand the broker/lender relationship and how commission can influence the sale. The FCA's current guidance calls for prominent, timely, understandable disclosures. Consumer Duty addresses products and services, price and value, consumer understanding and support.

Historical motor-finance commission redress is a changing regulatory area. Use the current FCA page for eligibility, legal challenges and deadlines; this guide does not promise compensation or freeze a claims timetable.

FCA · commission communication FCA · Consumer Duty FCA · claims updates

Business VAT, tax and accounting

Confirm vehicle classification, VAT registration, private use and invoice components. HMRC describes a 50% input-VAT restriction for relevant leased cars available for private use, subject to rules and exceptions; it is not a blanket entitlement for every business or vehicle.

Company-car benefit, salary sacrifice, capital allowances and accounting treatment need the current tax year and actual circumstances. Do not reuse personal gross rentals as business net costs or assume every finance payment is deductible.

HMRC · VAT GOV.UK · company-car tax HMRC · salary sacrifice

EVs and operating conditions

Do not assume an EV has no vehicle tax: current rules depend on registration, vehicle and tax period. Check any expensive-car supplement and whether a lease includes tax increases.

Ask about battery ownership and warranty, usable range, charging connection, cable provision, energy costs and maintenance. Check local clean-air rules against the actual vehicle and location rather than its marketing label.

GOV.UK · EV vehicle tax GOV.UK · clean-air zones

09 / CONTRACT-READINESS REVIEW

Before signing

A personal review aid, not lender approval or a compliance certification. Ticks remain only in this open page; no information is submitted or stored.

- [ ] Customer/entity, payer, signer and legal lender are correct.
- [ ] Vehicle identity, specification, condition, price and delivery date are agreed.
- [ ] Seller and lender identity/permissions have been checked through appropriate channels.
- [ ] Deposit, contributions, trade-in and old settlement reconcile without double counting.
- [ ] Product legal form, ownership path and optional versus mandatory final payment are understood.
- [ ] Payment schedule, APR where applicable, total payable and every fee match the accepted quote.
- [ ] Running costs and any final-payment funding plan fit the budget.
- [ ] Mileage, service duties, maintenance, insurance and return-condition terms are clear.
- [ ] Pre-contract documents, commission explanation and answers to questions are available.
- [ ] Withdrawal, settlement, termination, default and complaint processes are understood.
- [ ] All approval conditions and changes are resolved; the final contract matches the quote.
- [ ] Signed copy, receipts, handover evidence and first-payment/account details will be retained.

Reset checklist

10 / SHARED VOCABULARY

Domain glossary

Cash price / on-the-road price

Agreed purchase price; identify which delivery, registration, tax or extras it includes.

Deposit / contribution / initial rental

Customer purchase deposit, promotional contribution and lease initial rental have different sources and meanings.

Amount of credit / principal

Financed balance defined by the agreement, distinct from total repayments and vehicle price.

APR

Annual percentage rate representing credit cost under applicable calculation rules; not simply a flat or nominal annual rate.

Total charge for credit / total payable

Credit charges versus the agreement's total payment obligation. Inspect exactly what each disclosure includes.

Balloon / optional final payment

Deferred large sum. PCP purchase payment may be optional; a lease-purchase balloon normally remains due.

GFV / GMFV / residual value

Future-value terminology. A contractual return undertaking differs from a non-guaranteed forecast resale value.

Equity / negative equity

Vehicle valuation above/below outstanding settlement, after relevant adjustments. Equity is not guaranteed.

Broker / captive lender

Broker introduces or arranges finance; a captive finance provider is associated with a manufacturer/group. Identify the legal lender separately.

Soft / hard credit search

Different search types and credit-record effects; verify the specific check and disclosure before proceeding.

Regulated agreement / legal form

Legal status governs rights and duties. Neither "business" nor a marketing product name alone settles that status.

PCIs / adequate explanation

Pre-contract information and explanation help a customer understand obligations and suitability before commitment.

Settlement / voluntary termination / surrender

Repayment to close finance, a qualifying statutory termination route, and agreed vehicle surrender are distinct processes.

Fair wear and tear / excess mileage

Return standards and contractual usage charges. Check the actual guide and charge schedule supplied.

Keeper / legal owner

Person recorded for vehicle keeping responsibilities versus the person/entity holding title. They can differ.

Net / VAT / gross · VED · BIK

Before tax / VAT / inclusive price; vehicle excise duty; taxable benefit-in-kind for applicable company benefits.

Terminology follows the linked product, regulatory and tax references; agreement wording should be retained in requirements.

11 / KNOWLEDGE → ARTIFACTS

How to use this domain in the project

This file is a human-readable reference. Adding it to navigation does not automatically send its contents to application agents or create approved business rules.

Layer	Role	Evidence to retain
Public domain guide	Explain terminology, relationships and questions; identify missing requirements.	Topic ID/section, source URL, review date and reference status
Profile knowledge documents	Configured reference context for applicable agent stages; source citations need verification.	Exact document/section and fingerprint; preview is not proof of use
Domain configuration	`workspace/auto-finance-domain.toml` supplies selected product/journey references and explicitly approved rules.	Rule ID, version, owner, status, source and scope
Requirements & baseline	Approved product definitions, calculations, boundaries and legal/commercial decisions.	Versioned requirement, approval and unresolved questions
Stories → scenarios → tests	Transform approved scope into behaviour and expected outcomes.	Requirement/rule mappings, validated calculations and input provenance
Execution & coverage graph	Record actual runs and trace the approved requirement to results.	Configured environment, discovered/executed cases and actual runner evidence

Example: a PCP quotation requirement

Domain topics: optional final payment, deposit, mileage, total payable, future value and return conditions.

Questions for the owner: which lender/product version, accepted term/mileage limits, approved pricing/APR method, exact fees and source for GFV? Who owns the rule and its effective date?

Possible story: display the approved quote components and end choices for the selected product.

Possible scenarios: valid inputs reconcile; boundary inputs use approved limits; price changes invalidate an old quote; an unavailable pricing/GFV service leaves the quote incomplete; displayed documents match the accepted version.

Expected results: require approved examples and pricing-service outputs. This guide's synthetic cash-total examples do not establish a lender pricing oracle, an approval decision or statutory APR.

> Current catalogue documentation declares the configured market `unspecified` until an owner supplies it. This guide is explicitly UK-scoped; it does not silently change that runtime setting or widen the approved quotation BRD.

Open domain knowledge · Open saved coverage graph · Open calculation checks

12 / PROVENANCE

Source register and review needs

Research date: 13 October 2026. Sources describe products or rules in their own scope; the guide's use cases and journey gates are editorial synthesis. Offers, lender relationships, tax rules and redress processes can change. No promotional APR, acceptance threshold or compensation amount is supplied.

1. MoneyHelper: buying a car — options and comparison.
2. MoneyHelper: Hire Purchase — ownership and repayments.
3. MoneyHelper: PCP — optional final payment and end choices.
4. MoneyHelper: PCH — rental, usage and return.
5. MoneyHelper: personal loans — separate borrowing and withdrawal.
6. MoneyHelper: running costs — total budget.
7. GOV.UK: used-vehicle checks — DVLA, MOT, VIN, recalls and handover obligations.
8. FCA: creditworthiness and affordability — distinct assessment concerns.
9. FCA Handbook: CONC 4.2 — pre-contract information and explanation.
10. FCA: communicating about commission — disclosure and understanding.
11. FCA: Consumer Duty — consumer outcomes.
12. FCA Firm Checker — permissions and identity.
13. FCA: car finance claims — live historical commission/redress updates.
14. MoneyHelper: early exit — settlement and termination.
15. Consumer Credit Act s66A · s99 · s100 — primary legal references; legislation pages require direct reading for full detail.
16. MoneyHelper: consumer rights · Financial Ombudsman: car finance — defects and complaints.
17. HMRC VAT Notice 700/64 · company-car tax · salary sacrifice — business treatment.
18. GOV.UK: EV vehicle tax · clean-air zones — operating obligations.
19. BVRLA consumer advice — return guidance; obtain the provider's full agreed standard.
20. Official brand/lender product pages linked in sections 03 and 05 — examples and product naming, not independent recommendations.

For business approval: product/policy owners should verify definitions and thresholds; legal/compliance should verify applicable rights and disclosure; pricing should supply calculation methods and expected vectors; tax/accounting should verify business treatment. Record owner, version, effective date and source before promoting reference material into approved rules.

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